



Louise Thomson
THE PLAYBOOK

THE COMPLETE GUIDE · 2026

CREATOR · SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGER · BUSINESS OWNER

The Complete Creator Playbook

The full step-by-step system — from your first post to a paid, full-time business. Content, social media management, branding, websites, pricing and growth. Everything, in order.

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START HERE

Read this first.

This is the guide I wish I'd had when I started. No fluff, no gatekeeping — just the exact steps I used to go from a 9–5 to a full-time creator and business owner, written so a complete beginner can follow it.

You do not need to be famous, technical, or lucky. You need a skill people pay for, a system to deliver it, and the consistency to keep going. That's learnable — and it's all in here.

How to use this playbook

- ✦ **Go in order the first time.** Each module builds on the last — foundations, then the three ways to earn, then branding, websites, pricing and growth.
- ✦ **Do the actions.** Every module ends with a step to take. Reading changes nothing; doing changes everything.
- ✦ **Pick one path to start.** Content creator, social media manager, or your own business — you can add the others later.
- ✦ **Keep it beside you.** Come back to the pricing, scripts and checklists whenever you need them.

A promise: if you finish this guide and take the actions, you will know exactly how to earn your first £1,000 online — and how to turn that into a full-time income.



WHAT'S INSIDE

Twelve modules — the whole industry.

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How it flows: learn to create & get found (1–3), turn it into paid client work & an agency (4–5), look professional (6–7), price & set up the business properly (8–9), then grow, launch and scale — with my team and AI behind you (10–12).



A woman with long brown hair, wearing a leopard print dress, is sitting at a bar. She is looking towards the camera with a slight smile. Her right arm is raised, touching her hair. The bar has a marble top and a backlit shelf filled with various liquor bottles. In the background, there are more bottles and a warm, ambient light.

MODULE 01

Foundations & Mindset

Before the tactics: the opportunity, the paths, your niche, and the numbers you're aiming at. Get this right and everything else gets easier.

The opportunity

Choose your path

Find your niche

Set your goals



THE OPPORTUNITY

The best time in history to start.

The creator economy is one of the fastest-growing industries on earth — and businesses everywhere now need people who understand social media. You are early, not late.

£0

Startup cost — you already own a phone

2–3 hrs

A day is enough to start on the side

Global

Your market is the whole internet

Why this works now

- ✦ **Every business needs content.** Most owners have no time and no clue — they'll happily pay you to do it.
- ✦ **Attention is the new currency.** If you can hold attention, you can earn from it in a dozen ways.
- ✦ **The tools are free.** The same phone in your pocket built million-pound brands.
- ✦ **You can start tiny.** One client, one video, one product — then compound.

Reframe: you're not "trying to go viral." You're building a **skill set** — content, growth, and management — that the market pays for whether you have 500 followers or 5 million.

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CHOOSE YOUR PATH

Three ways to earn.

There are three routes into this industry. They overlap, and most people eventually run all three — but pick **one** to start so you actually make progress.



Content Creator

You grow your own audience and get paid through brand deals, UGC, affiliates and your own products.

Best if: you want to build a personal brand



Social Media Manager

You run social accounts for other businesses on a monthly fee. Reliable, recurring income — fast.

Best if: you want money soonest



Business Owner

You package it all — agency, websites, products, coaching — into a company that can run without you.

Best if: you want to scale big

Which should you start with?

- ✦ **Need income in 30 days?** Start as a **Social Media Manager** — you can land a paying client before you have any following.
- ✦ **Love being on camera?** Start as a **Content Creator** and add management once you understand the platforms.
- ✦ **Already have a following or a skill?** Go straight to **Business Owner** and productise it.

Do this now: circle the path that fits you today. You'll follow its module first — but read them all.

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FIND YOUR NICHE

Get specific. Get paid.

"I'll post about everything" is the fastest way to grow nothing. A niche makes you easy to follow, easy to book, and easy to recommend.

The niche formula

Passion × Skill × Demand. Something you enjoy, something you're decent at (or willing to learn), and something people already spend money on.

Proven, profitable niches

- ✦ Beauty & skincare
- ✦ Fitness & wellness
- ✦ Fashion & styling
- ✦ Food & recipes
- ✦ Travel & lifestyle
- ✦ Home & interiors
- ✦ Money & business
- ✦ Parenting & family
- ✦ Local business (huge for SMM)
- ✦ Tech, gaming & AI

Niche down with the "who + what + why"

- ✦ **Who** you help — e.g. "busy mums", "local gyms", "new coaches".
- ✦ **What** you help them do — "eat well in 15 minutes", "get more members".
- ✦ **Why** you — your story, your taste, your results.

Do this now: write one sentence — "I help [who] to [what] through [content/social media]." That's your positioning.

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SET YOUR GOALS

Aim at a real number.

Vague goals get vague results. Decide what you want to earn and work backwards — the internet doesn't cap your income, so the target is yours to set.

Example income ladders

Level	What it looks like	Monthly
Side income	1 SMM client or a few UGC videos	£500–£1,000
Part-time	2–3 clients or steady brand deals	£1,500–£3,000
Full-time	Replace the 9–5, mixed income streams	£4,000–£8,000
Scaling	Agency / products / big deals	£10,000–£20,000+

Work backwards

- ✦ Want **£2,000/month**? That's just **2 clients at £1,000**, or 8–10 UGC videos, or one solid brand deal a week.
- ✦ Break the number into **units you can count** — clients, videos, deals — then chase the units, not the money.

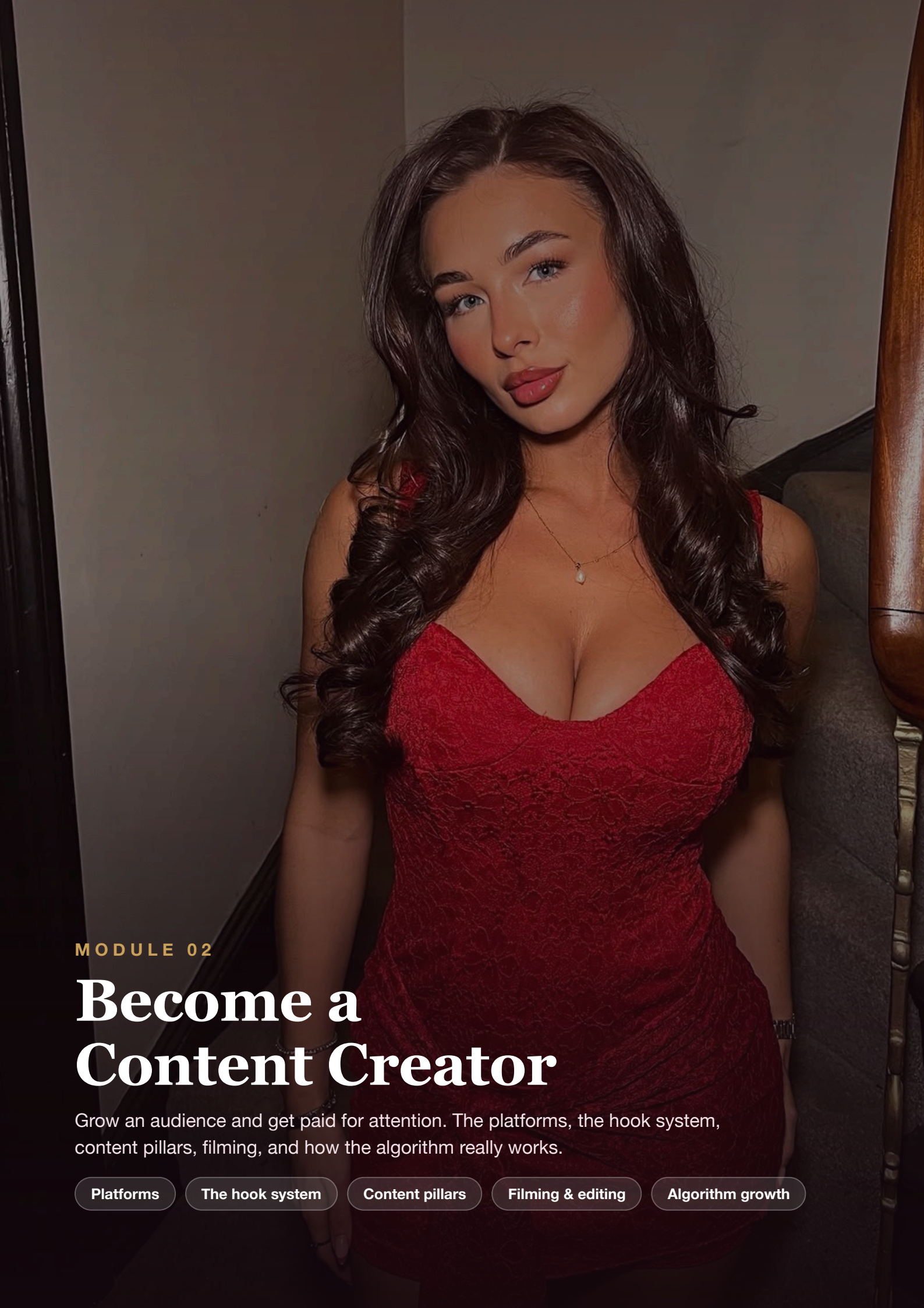
Your income is a decision, not a wage.

Nobody is going to give you a raise. In this game you give yourself one by adding a client, a stream, or a price rise.

Do this now: write your 90-day income target and the number of units it takes to hit it.

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MODULE 02

Become a Content Creator

Grow an audience and get paid for attention. The platforms, the hook system, content pillars, filming, and how the algorithm really works.

Platforms

The hook system

Content pillars

Filming & editing

Algorithm growth



THE ROLE

What a creator actually does.

A content creator turns ideas into posts that grow an audience — then turns that audience into income. Your job is two things: **make things people want to watch**, and **build trust**.

Where to post (and why)



TikTok

Fastest growth. Best place to start from zero — the algorithm shows new creators to new people.



Instagram

Where brands look and money lives. Reels for reach, feed & stories for trust.



YouTube

Long-term authority and searchable income (incl. Shorts). Slower, but compounds.

Start with one platform (I recommend TikTok), master it, then repurpose the same content everywhere. One idea → many posts.

The creator's weekly job

- ♦ **Plan** — decide the week's ideas from your pillars.
- ♦ **Batch** — film several at once; it's 10x more efficient.
- ♦ **Post & engage** — reply to every comment for the first hour.
- ♦ **Review** — check which posts worked and do more of that.

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EVERY PLATFORM

Know every channel.

You'll start on one, but a real creator (and every business) should understand them all — each one does a different job. Here's the full map.

Platform	Best for	Post this
TikTok	Fastest growth from zero	Short video, trends, hooks
Instagram	Brand deals & trust	Reels, carousels, stories
YouTube	Authority & search (long-life)	Long video + Shorts
Facebook	Local business & older buyers	Reels, groups, events
LinkedIn	B2B, clients & services	Posts, thought-leadership
Pinterest	Evergreen traffic (fashion, food, home)	Pins linking to your site
X / Twitter	News, niche communities	Text, threads, replies
Snapchat	Younger, close audience	Casual daily stories
Threads	Fast-growing, conversational	Short text, community

The smart play: create once, repurpose everywhere. One filming session becomes a TikTok, a Reel, a Short, a Pin and a post — five platforms, one effort.



Not sure which platforms are right for you or your business? **DM @lou1sethomson** and we'll map it out for you.

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THE HOOK SYSTEM

Win the first 2 seconds.

People decide in about two seconds whether to keep watching. Master the **hook** and everything else takes care of itself — it's the single biggest lever in short-form video.

Hook formulas that work

- ♦ **The bold claim** — "This grew my page to 100k in 30 days."
- ♦ **The mistake** — "Stop doing this if you want to grow."
- ♦ **Curiosity gap** — "Nobody tells you this about brand deals..."
- ♦ **Relatable call-out** — "POV: you're posting and getting no views."
- ♦ **Result first** — show the after, then explain how.

Retention beats everything. After the hook, keep them watching: fast cuts, on-screen captions, one idea per video, and a reason to reach the end (a payoff, a list, a reveal).

The simple video structure

- 1 Hook (0–2s)**
Stop the scroll with one of the formulas above.
- 2 Value (2–20s)**
Deliver the thing you promised — clearly, quickly, one idea.
- 3 Payoff + CTA**
End strong. Tell them to follow, comment, or save.

Do this now: write 10 hooks for your niche. Film the 3 best today.

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PILLARS & CALENDAR

Never run out of ideas.

Content pillars are 3–5 themes you always post about. They keep you consistent, on-brand, and out of the "what do I post today?" trap.

Example pillars (fitness creator)

- ✦ **Educate** — tips, how-tos, myths
- ✦ **Relate** — day-in-the-life, struggles
- ✦ **Inspire** — transformations, wins
- ✦ **Sell** — products, services, offers

The 3:1 rule — for every 3 posts that give value, 1 can sell. Give far more than you ask.

A simple weekly calendar

Day	Pillar	Format
Mon	Educate	Talking-head tip
Wed	Relate	Day-in-the-life
Fri	Inspire	Result / story
Sun	Sell / trend	Offer or trending audio

Batch it: film a whole week in one 90-minute session. Consistency is the algorithm's favourite thing.

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FILMING & EDITING

Make it look pro (on a phone).

You do not need a fancy camera. You need good light, clear sound, and clean edits. Here's the whole kit and the workflow.

The £0–£100 kit

- ✦ **Your phone** — the camera is plenty good.
- ✦ **Natural light** or a cheap ring light.
- ✦ **A tripod / phone stand** (~£15).
- ✦ **A clip mic** for talking videos (~£25).

Best free editing apps

- ✦ **CapCut** — the industry standard, free.
- ✦ **InShot** — quick and simple.
- ✦ **In-app editors** — post natively for reach.

The editing checklist

- ✓ **Captions on** — most people watch on mute.
- ✓ **Cut the dead air** — trim every pause; keep it snappy.
- ✓ **Trending or clean audio** — check the platform's trending sounds.
- ✓ **Hook on screen** — put your hook as text in the first frame.
- ✓ **Vertical & full-screen** — 9:16, no borders.

Done beats perfect. Your 50th video will be miles better than your first — so get to your 50th fast.

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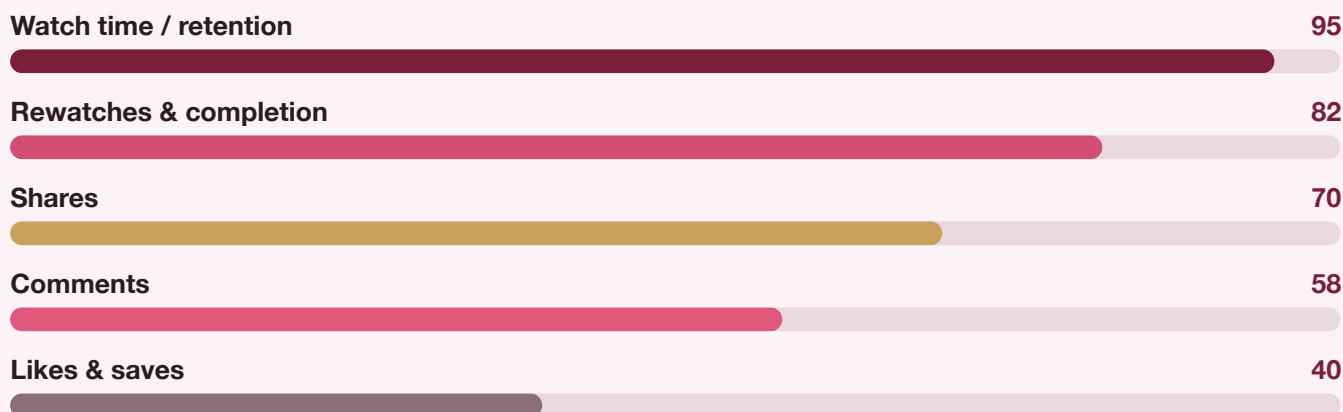


GROW YOUR FOLLOWING

How the algorithm really works.

The algorithm isn't magic. It shows a video to a small test group, watches how they react, and pushes the winners to more people. Your job is to win the test.

The signals that matter (in order)



- ✦ **Hook for retention** — the more they watch, the more it spreads.
- ✦ **Make it shareable** — a share is the strongest signal; give people a reason to send it to a friend.
- ✦ **Reply to comments** — early engagement tells the algorithm it's hot.
- ✦ **Post consistently** — 1x/day beats 7x on Monday and nothing after.
- ✦ **Ride trends fast** — trending audio and formats get a boost.

Don't chase followers — chase reach. Views bring followers, brand deals and clients. A single video can change your life; I've had 18.3M likes on one post.

Do this now: post one video a day for 14 days. Review what worked on day 15.

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IDEAS & REPURPOSING

Never stare at a blank screen.

Two things kill consistency: running out of ideas, and burning out making them. Here's a bank of ideas you can pull from forever, and how to turn one idea into a week of content.

10 video ideas that always work

- ◆ How-to / tutorial
- ◆ Common mistakes in your niche
- ◆ Myth vs truth
- ◆ Day in the life
- ◆ Before & after / transformation
- ◆ "Things I wish I knew"
- ◆ Answer a follower question
- ◆ Product/tool you love
- ◆ Story time (a lesson learned)
- ◆ Trend, adapted to your niche

One idea → a week of content

1 Pick one topic
e.g. "how I plan a week of content".

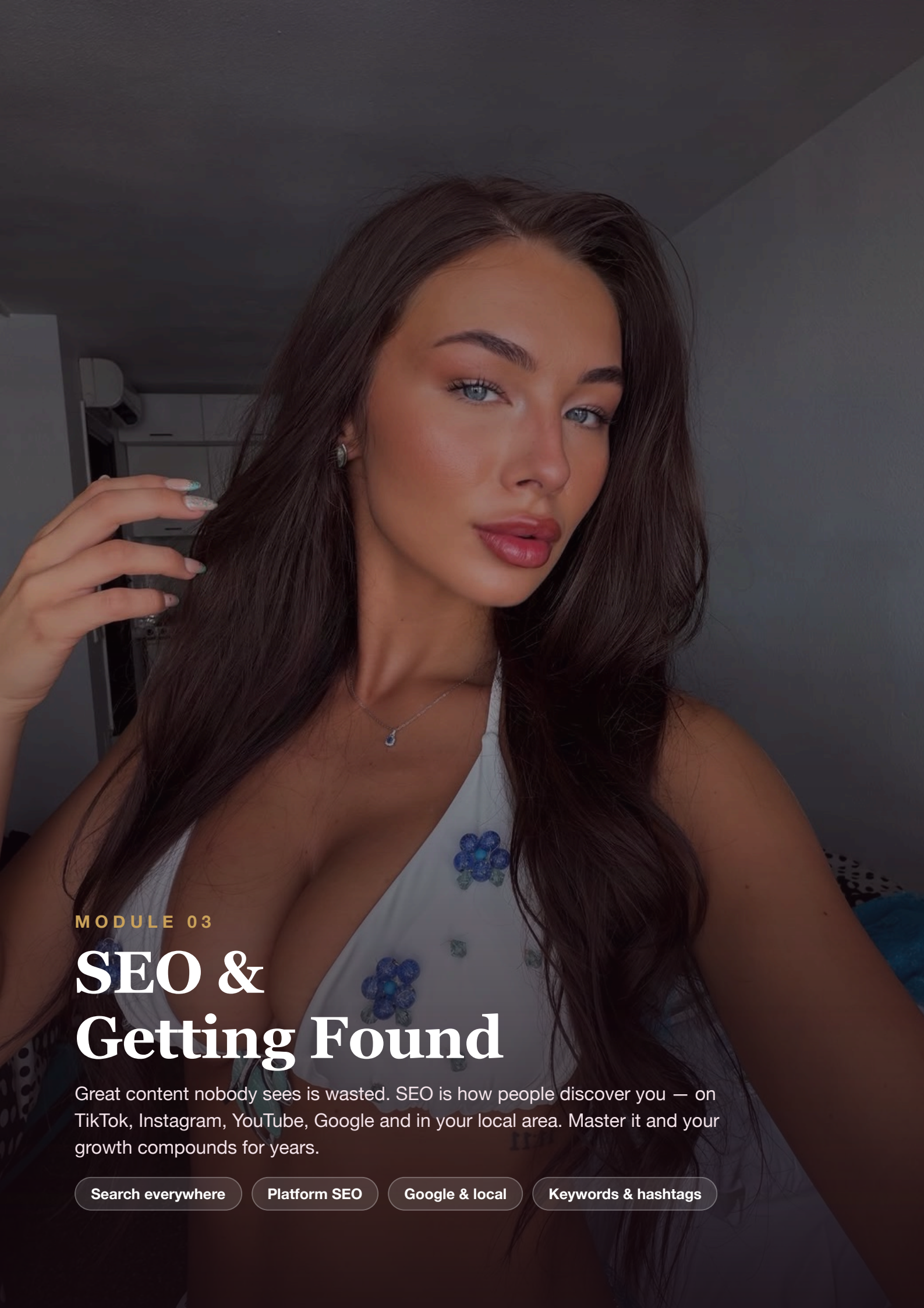
2 Split it up
The quick tip, the deep how-to, the mistake to avoid, a result, a Q&A.

3 Reformat it
Video, carousel, story, a written post, an email — same idea, five places.

Keep a notes list of every idea the moment it hits you. You'll never open the app with nothing to say again.

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MODULE 03

SEO & Getting Found

Great content nobody sees is wasted. SEO is how people discover you — on TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, Google and in your local area. Master it and your growth compounds for years.

Search everywhere

Platform SEO

Google & local

Keywords & hashtags



WHY SEO MATTERS

Get found, not just seen.

Most creators only think about the feed. Smart ones think about **search**. Every day millions of people **search** TikTok, Instagram, YouTube and Google for exactly what you do — SEO puts you in front of them, on autopilot.

Feed vs search — why search wins long-term

- ✦ **Feed content** spikes then dies in 48 hours.
- ✦ **Search content** keeps getting found for months and years — it compounds.
- ✦ **Intent is higher** — someone searching "best gym in Glasgow" is ready to buy, not just scroll.

The 3 layers of getting found



Platform search

Ranking inside TikTok, Instagram & YouTube search.



Google & web

Your website & YouTube showing up on Google.



Local search

Getting found by people in your area — huge for clients.



Want a keyword plan for your niche or business? **DM @lou1sethomson** and we'll build one.

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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PLATFORM SEO

Rank inside the apps.

TikTok, Instagram and YouTube are search engines now. Here's how to rank in each so your content gets found long after you post it.

The universal rules

- ✦ **Say your keyword out loud** in the first 3 seconds — the apps transcribe your audio.
- ✦ **Put the keyword in your on-screen text, caption and file/first comment.**
- ✦ **Use specific search terms** people actually type ("high-protein breakfast", not "yum").

Platform	Ranks on	Do this
TikTok	Spoken words, captions, hashtags	Keyword in first line + audio
Instagram	Captions, alt text, keywords in bio	Keyword-rich captions & name field
YouTube	Title, description, tags	Keyword title + full description

Golden tip: your Instagram **name field** (not @handle) is searchable — put your niche there, e.g. "Ella · Glasgow SMM & Content".

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GOOGLE & LOCAL

Own Google & your area.

A website + Google presence makes you look real and gets you found by people ready to hire. And local SEO is a goldmine for social media managers chasing local clients.

Website SEO basics

- ★ **One keyword per page** — in the title, first heading and URL.
- ★ **Write for humans first**, then add keywords naturally.
- ★ **Fast & mobile** — Google ranks quick, mobile-friendly sites higher.
- ★ **Get links & mentions** — other sites linking to you builds authority.

Local SEO (clients love this)

- ★ **Google Business Profile** — free, and it puts businesses on the map. Setting these up is a paid service you can offer.
- ★ **Reviews** — more 5-star reviews = higher local ranking.
- ★ **Local keywords** — "[service] in [town]" on the website and posts.

Service idea: offer local businesses a "get found on Google" package — profile setup, reviews system and local content. Easy £300–£800.

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KEYWORDS & HASHTAGS

Words that get you found.

Keywords and hashtags are how the apps understand and file your content. Use them deliberately, not randomly.

How to find your keywords (free)

- ✦ **Type into the search bar** — the autocomplete suggestions are what people actually search.
- ✦ **Check "others searched for"** under results.
- ✦ **Read your comments** — the questions people ask are keywords.

The hashtag formula

- ✦ **3–5 focused tags** beat 30 random ones.
- ✦ **Mix sizes** — 1 big (broad reach), 2 medium (your niche), 1 small/branded (own it).
- ✦ **Make a branded hashtag** — yours alone, so fans and clients can find your world.

Captions are SEO too. Open with your keyword, write a real sentence a human would search, then your CTA. "Views" come from search as much as the feed.



Want your niche's exact keywords & hashtag sets done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson.**

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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MODULE 04

Become a Social Media Manager

The fastest way to real income. You don't need a following — you need a service and a system. Find clients, pitch, onboard, deliver and keep them.

The services

Find clients

Pitch scripts

Onboarding

Reporting



THE ROLE

Get paid to run their socials.

Millions of businesses know they need social media and have zero time or skill to do it. That gap is your income. As an SMM you run their accounts for a **monthly fee** — recurring, predictable money.

Services you can offer

- ◆ **Content creation** — posts, reels, stories
- ◆ **Scheduling & posting**
- ◆ **Caption & hashtag writing**
- ◆ **Community management** — replies & DMs
- ◆ **Strategy & content plans**
- ◆ **Filming days** at their business
- ◆ **Paid ads** (add-on, higher fee)
- ◆ **Monthly reporting**

You can start today with zero following. Clients pay for the **outcome** (more customers, a professional presence), not your personal follower count.

Who to target first

- ◆ **Local businesses** — gyms, salons, cafés, dentists, trades, restaurants.
- ◆ **Small brands** that post inconsistently or badly.
- ◆ **Coaches & service pros** who are great at their thing, bad at posting.

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FIND CLIENTS

Where the clients hide.

You don't need thousands of leads. You need **a handful of the right conversations**. Here's exactly where to look and how to start them.

Where to find them

- ✦ **Instagram search** — local businesses with weak or dead pages. That's your pitch.
- ✦ **Google Maps** — every business near you, many with no socials linked.
- ✦ **Your own network** — the fastest first client is someone who already knows you.
- ✦ **Facebook groups & local directories** — small business owners hang out there.

The outreach that works

Lead with value, not a pitch. Point out one specific thing you'd improve, or send a free idea. Make it about them, not you.

DM / email script

"Hi [name], I love what you do at [business]. I put together a couple of quick content ideas that could bring you more [customers/bookings] — want me to send them over? No strings, I just work with local businesses like yours."

- ✦ **Follow up twice.** Most sales are in the follow-up, not the first message.
- ✦ **Aim for a call**, not a sale, in the DM. Sell on the call.

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PITCH & CLOSE

Turn a chat into a client.

On the call you're not begging for work — you're a professional diagnosing a problem and prescribing the fix. Follow this simple structure.

- 1 Ask & listen**
"What are you trying to get from social media?" Let them talk. Their words become your pitch.
- 2 Diagnose**
Reflect the gap: "So you want more bookings but you're posting twice a month with no plan."
- 3 Prescribe a package**
Offer one clear package with a monthly price. Don't overwhelm with options.
- 4 Handle price calmly**
Frame it as ROI: "One new customer a month covers this. I'll aim for far more."
- 5 Close**
"Shall we start Monday? I'll send the details and we'll get going."

Confidence is the close. You're solving a real problem. Say your price, then stop talking.

Do this now: book 3 calls this week. You only need one yes.

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ONBOARD & DELIVER

Run it like a pro.

Great delivery keeps clients paying for years. Set it up properly from day one and it runs like a machine.

The onboarding checklist

- ✓ **Contract signed** & first invoice paid before any work.
- ✓ **Access** — logins or added as a manager (never post from your own login).
- ✓ **Brand basics** — logo, colours, fonts, tone, do's & don'ts.
- ✓ **Content plan** approved for month one.
- ✓ **Filming day** booked to bank a batch of content.

The monthly workflow

Week	What you do
1	Plan the month, film/gather content, get approval
2–3	Schedule & post, manage comments & DMs
4	Engage, review numbers, prep next month's plan
End	Send the report, invoice for next month

Batch across clients. Do all planning on one day, all editing on another. Systems let you handle 5+ clients without burning out.

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KEEP CLIENTS

Results = retention.

Winning a client is hard; keeping one is easy — if you show results and communicate. A retained client is money every single month without re-selling.

The monthly report (keep it simple)

- ✦ **Reach & views** — up or down vs last month.
- ✦ **Follower growth** and engagement rate.
- ✦ **Best posts** — what worked and why.
- ✦ **Leads / bookings / clicks** — the number they actually care about.
- ✦ **Next month's plan** — always end looking forward.

Communicate proactively. A quick weekly message ("here's what's going out this week") makes clients feel looked after — and stops them ever wondering what they pay for.

Grow the account (and the invoice)

- ✦ Once you're delivering, **upsell**: ads, a second platform, a filming day, a website.
- ✦ Ask happy clients for **referrals and a testimonial** — your next clients come from your current ones.

Do this now: build a one-page report template you can reuse for every client.

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A woman with long brown hair and blue eyes, wearing a black polka-dot dress with a white bow at the waist, stands against a rough stone wall. She is looking directly at the camera with a slight smile. The wall is made of irregular stones and has a dark horizontal band running across it. The lighting is warm and focused on the woman.

MODULE 05

Build a Social Media Agency

Turn a one-person hustle into a company. Systems, a team, and delivery that runs without you — this is how a freelancer becomes an agency owner earning while they sleep.

Freelancer → agency

Systems & SOPs

Hire a team

Deliver at scale





FREELANCER → AGENCY

From doing it to owning it.

A freelancer sells their time. An **agency** sells an outcome and delivers it with a team and systems. That's how you break past the ceiling of "hours in the day" and build something that runs — and sells — without you doing every task.

The 4 stages of growth

1

Solo

You do everything for 1–3 clients. Prove you can deliver results.

2

Systemised

You turn how you work into repeatable processes (next page).

3

Small team

You outsource tasks — editing, then posting — and manage instead of do.

4

Agency

A team delivers, you sell & lead. 10+ clients, real profit.

Niche the agency. "Social media for gyms" or "for restaurants" beats "for anyone" — you get referrals, reuse content ideas, and can charge more as the specialist.



Building an agency? **DM @lou1sethomson** — we help creators set up and scale their own.

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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SYSTEMS & SOPS

Make yourself replaceable.

Systems are what let you hand work over without quality dropping. Every time you do a task, write down how — that's a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP), and it's the backbone of an agency.

The core systems to build

- ✦ **Client onboarding** — the exact steps from "yes" to first post.
- ✦ **Content production** — plan → film → edit → approve → schedule.
- ✦ **Reporting** — one template, filled in monthly.
- ✦ **Communication** — when & how you update clients.

Tools that run the machine

- ✦ **Notion / Trello / ClickUp** — your client & content hub.
- ✦ **Scheduler** (Later, Metricool) — post without logging in daily.
- ✦ **Shared drive** — every client's content, organised.
- ✦ **Loom** — record how you do things once, train anyone.

Rule: if you've done it twice, write the SOP. Your future team (and future self) will thank you.

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HIRE YOUR TEAM

Buy back your time.

You can't scale alone. The good news: you hire in the right order, starting with the tasks you like least, and each hire pays for themselves by freeing you to win more clients.

Who to hire, in order

Hire	They take over	Rough cost
1. Video editor	The most time-consuming task	£5–£20 / video
2. Virtual assistant	Scheduling, DMs, admin	£4–£12 / hour
3. Content creator/filmer	Client filming days	Per day / freelance
4. Account manager	Running clients day-to-day	Salary / %

Where to find them

- ✦ **Upwork, Fiverr, OnlineJobs.ph** — freelancers & VAs worldwide.
- ✦ **Instagram & TikTok** — hire editors whose work you already like.
- ✦ **Your audience** — your followers often want to work with you.

Hire freelance first. Start per-task, not salaried. Scale the hours as your client list grows — never the other way round.

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DELIVER AT SCALE

Quality with 10+ clients.

The danger as you grow is quality slipping. Systems + batching keep every client feeling like your only client — even when you have twenty.

Batch everything

- ★ **Theme your days** — Monday plan all clients, Tuesday film, Wednesday edit, Thursday schedule, Friday engage & report.
- ★ **Templatise** — reuse formats and structures across clients (not content).
- ★ **Schedule a month ahead** so nothing is ever last-minute.

Keep clients happy at scale

- ★ **Same-day replies** — speed feels like care.
- ★ **Monthly report + a quick Loom** walking them through it.
- ★ **Under-promise, over-deliver** — one surprise extra a month.

10 clients × £1,000 = £10k/month — mostly delivered by your team.

That's the whole point of an agency: your income stops being tied to your hours.

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MODULE 06

Branding That Sells

People buy brands they trust. This is how to build a look and a voice — for yourself and for clients — that feels premium and converts.

Brand foundations

Visual identity

Voice & bio

Positioning



FOUNDATIONS

A brand is a feeling.

Your brand is what people feel when they see your name. Nail the fundamentals and you become memorable, recommendable and premium — able to charge more.

The five brand foundations

- ◆ **Purpose** — what you stand for and who you help.
- ◆ **Personality** — are you bold, warm, luxe, playful, expert?
- ◆ **Promise** — the result people get from you.
- ◆ **Look** — colours, fonts, imagery (next page).
- ◆ **Voice** — how you sound in captions and DMs.

Consistency is the whole trick. Same colours, same tone, same energy — everywhere. Repetition builds recognition, and recognition builds trust.

People don't buy the best product. They buy the brand they trust the most.

Do this now: write three words that describe how you want people to feel about your brand. Everything you make should match them.

LT





VISUAL IDENTITY

Your look, locked in.

A simple, consistent visual identity makes you look established — even on day one. You only need a few decisions, then you repeat them forever.

Colours

- ✦ Pick **1 main, 1 accent, 1–2 neutrals**.
- ✦ Use them consistently across posts, highlights and your site.
- ✦ Colour creates instant recognition in a busy feed.

Fonts

- ✦ One characterful **heading** font.
- ✦ One clean **body** font.
- ✦ Never more than two — it looks messy.

The starter brand kit

- ✓ **Logo / wordmark** — even just your name in your font.
- ✓ **Colour palette** — hex codes saved.
- ✓ **2 fonts** — heading + body.
- ✓ **Profile photo & highlight covers** — on-brand.
- ✓ **Templates** — a couple of reusable post layouts (Canva is perfect).

Tool tip: build the whole kit free in **Canva**. Save it as a Brand Kit so every design stays consistent.

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VOICE & BIO

Sound like someone worth following.

Your words do as much as your visuals. A clear voice and a sharp bio turn profile visits into follows and enquiries.

Find your voice

- ✦ Write like you **talk** — read captions out loud; if it sounds stiff, rewrite.
- ✦ Pick a lane: **warm & relatable**, **bold & direct**, or **expert & calm**.
- ✦ Be consistent so people can "hear" you.

The bio formula

[Who you help] + [what you help them do] + [proof or personality] + [call to action].

e.g. "Helping local gyms fill classes with scroll-stopping content 🦋 300k+ views for clients · DM 'GROW' to start."

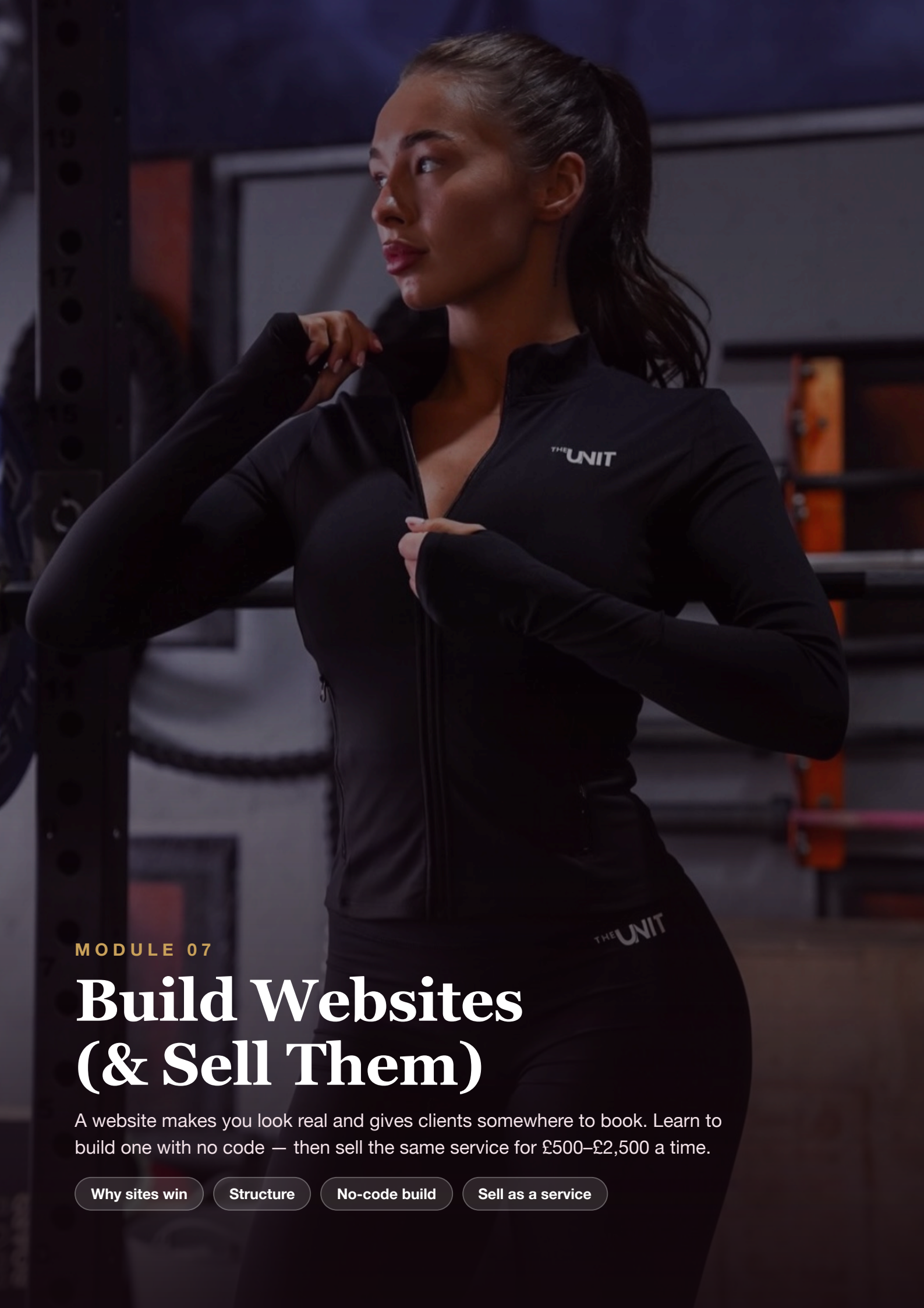
Positioning: be the obvious choice

- ✦ **Niche + result** beats "I do social media." Specific gets booked.
- ✦ Show **proof** — results, testimonials, before/after — the moment you have any.
- ✦ Have **one clear next step** everywhere (follow, DM a word, click the link).

Do this now: rewrite your bio with the formula above.

LT





MODULE 07

Build Websites (& Sell Them)

A website makes you look real and gives clients somewhere to book. Learn to build one with no code — then sell the same service for £500–£2,500 a time.

Why sites win

Structure

No-code build

Sell as a service



WHY & WHAT

Every brand needs a home.

Social media is rented land; a website is land you own. It's where people book you, buy from you, and take you seriously — and it's a service you can sell to every client.

What a great site does

- ✦ **Builds trust** — a real site says "real business".
- ✦ **Captures leads** — enquiry forms, email sign-ups.
- ✦ **Sells 24/7** — services, products, bookings.
- ✦ **Shows proof** — portfolio, testimonials, results.

The pages almost every site needs

Page	Job
Home	Hook, what you do, proof, clear call-to-action
About	Story & trust — why you
Services / Shop	What they can buy and the price/next step
Portfolio	Results & testimonials
Contact / Book	Form, calendar, socials

One golden rule: every page points to one clear action — book, buy, or enquire.

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BUILD IT (NO CODE)

Live in a weekend.

You do not need to code. Modern drag-and-drop builders let anyone make a beautiful, professional site — here's the workflow I use.

Pick a builder

Wix / Squarespace

Easiest for beginners. Gorgeous templates, drag-and-drop, hosting built in.

Framer / Carrd

Sleek and modern. Carrd is perfect (and cheap) for one-page sites.

Shopify

The choice when they're selling products online.

The build steps

1 Start from a template

Pick one close to the vibe — don't start blank.

2 Swap in their brand

Colours, fonts, logo, photos, real copy.

3 Write clear copy

Benefit-led headlines, short paragraphs, buttons everywhere.

4 Connect the essentials

Domain, contact form, socials, booking/payment.

5 Check mobile & launch

Most visitors are on a phone — test it there first.

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SELL IT

Turn a skill into £500–£2,500.

Once you can build one site, you can build them for clients — and it pairs perfectly with social media management. Same clients, extra income.

Website packages

Package	What's included	Price
One-pager	Single scrolling page, form, socials	£400–£800
Business site	4–6 pages, copy, branding, SEO basics	£900–£2,500
Online shop	Products, payments, setup & training	£2,500–£6,000
Care plan	Hosting, updates & edits (recurring)	£30–£100/mo

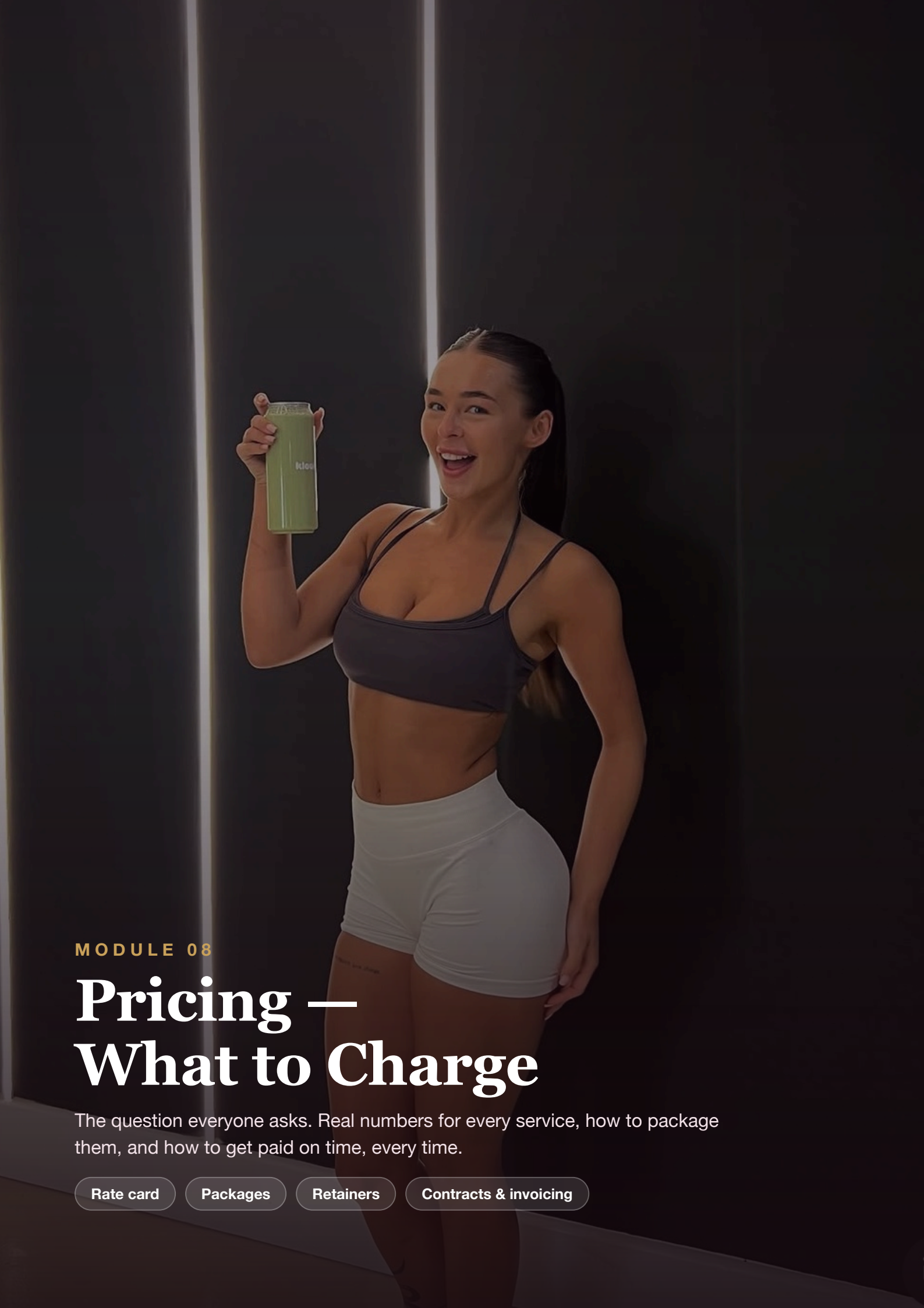
The care plan is the gold. Build once, then charge monthly to maintain it — recurring income on top of the build fee.

- ✦ **Bundle it:** "Website + social media management" is an easy, high-value offer.
- ✦ **Show, don't tell:** build one demo site for a dream client and use it to win more.

Do this now: rebuild a local business's weak site as a free demo. It becomes your portfolio and your pitch.

LT



A woman with long dark hair, wearing a dark grey sports bra and white high-waisted shorts, is smiling and holding a green smoothie in a clear bottle. The bottle has the word "klos" on it. She is standing in front of a dark background with two vertical light streaks.

MODULE 08

Pricing — What to Charge

The question everyone asks. Real numbers for every service, how to package them, and how to get paid on time, every time.

Rate card

Packages

Retainers

Contracts & invoicing



THE RATE CARD

What to actually charge.

Undercharging is the #1 mistake beginners make. Here are real market ranges — start near the lower end while you build proof, then raise your prices every few clients.

Service	What it is	Price
SMM — Starter	1 platform, ~12 posts/mo	£400–£600/mo
SMM — Growth	2 platforms, reels, engagement	£800–£1,200/mo
SMM — Premium	Full management + strategy + reporting	£1,500–£3,000/mo
UGC video	Single branded video	£120–£300
Brand deal post	Per platform (scales with reach)	£250–£2,000+
Content / filming day	Batch of photo & video	£400–£800
Website	One-pager → business site	£400–£2,500
Branding kit	Logo, colours, fonts, templates	£250–£1,500
Consulting / coaching	Per hour	£60–£150/hr

Price on value, not hours. A post that brings a client £5,000 is worth far more than the 30 minutes it took you.

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PACKAGES & RETAINERS

Sell outcomes, not tasks.

Never sell "posts". Sell a **package** with a clear outcome and a monthly price. Packages are easier to buy, easier to deliver, and far more profitable.

Build three tiers

Good

The essentials at an easy-yes price. Gets them in the door.

£400–£600/mo

Better

Your main offer — most clients pick this. Make it the obvious value.

£800–£1,200/mo

Best

Everything, done for them. Anchors your pricing and lands whales.

£1,500–£3,000/mo

The middle wins. Most people choose the middle option — so build your best offer there and price the others around it.

Why retainers change your life

- ♦ **Predictable income** — you start each month already earning.
- ♦ **Less selling** — win a client once, get paid for months.
- ♦ **Compounding** — 5 clients at £1,000 = £5,000/mo, every month.

Do this now: write your three packages with names, deliverables and prices.

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GET PAID PROPERLY

Contracts, invoices, protection.

Treat it like the business it is. A simple contract and clean invoicing protect you, build trust, and get you paid on time.

Always use a simple contract

- ✦ **Scope** — exactly what's included (and what's not).
- ✦ **Price & payment terms** — amount, date, how they pay.
- ✦ **Rolling monthly** with 30 days' notice to cancel.
- ✦ **Usage & access** — who owns what, logins.

Invoicing that gets paid

- ✓ **Invoice upfront** — payment before the month's work (or 50% up front on projects).
- ✓ **Use a tool** — free invoicing in Wave, PayPal, Stripe or Wise.
- ✓ **Set auto-reminders** — chase late payers automatically.
- ✓ **Keep records** — save every invoice for your tax return.

Register as self-employed once you're earning, and put ~20–30% aside for tax. Boring, but it keeps you free.

Do this now: set up a free invoicing account and save a contract template so you're ready for client one.

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MODULE 09

Set Up Your Business & Get Paid

The unsexy part that makes it real: registering, getting a business bank account, taking payments properly, staying on top of tax, and protecting yourself with contracts. Do this and you're a business, not a hobby.

Register

Banking & payments

Invoicing

Tax

Contracts & legal



REGISTER THE BUSINESS

Make it official.

You can start earning today, but once money is coming in you need to set up properly. It's simpler and cheaper than people fear — here's the plain-English version (UK-focused; check your country's rules).

Sole trader vs limited company

	Sole trader	Limited company
Setup	Register with HMRC, free, 10 min	Register at Companies House (~£50)
Best for	Starting out, lower income	Higher income, more protection
Admin	Simple — one tax return	More paperwork, an accountant helps
Liability	You & the business are one	Your personal assets are protected

Simple path: start as a **sole trader** to keep it easy. Switch to a **limited company** once you're earning well (often ~£30k+) — an accountant will tell you when it's worth it.

- ✦ **Pick a business name** (yours works: "Louise Thomson" / "LT Social").
- ✦ **Register for tax** as self-employed with HMRC.
- ✦ **Keep it simple** — you don't need an office, staff or fancy anything to begin.



Not sure how to set up? **DM @lou1sethomson** — we'll point you the right way.

LT





BANKING & PAYMENTS

How to actually take money.

Keep business money separate from personal from day one — it makes tax painless and looks professional. Then set up ways to get paid that clients trust and that chase themselves.

Get a business bank account

- ✦ **Free digital banks** — Starling, Tide, Monzo Business — open in minutes from your phone.
- ✦ **One account for all business in & out** — never mix with personal.

Ways to get paid

Method	Best for	Notes
Stripe	Cards, invoices, subscriptions	Pro, automatic, small fee
PayPal / Wise	Quick & international	Easy, widely trusted
GoCardless / direct debit	Monthly retainers	Auto-collects — no chasing
Bank transfer	Simple one-offs	No fees, but manual

For retainers, use auto-collection (Stripe subscription or direct debit). You get paid on the same day every month without lifting a finger — this is the secret to stress-free recurring income.

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INVOICING

Get paid on time, every time.

Clear invoicing gets you paid faster and makes you look like a pro. It takes minutes with the right tool — and it stops the awkward "have you paid yet?" conversations.

Invoice like a pro

- ✓ **Invoice upfront** — payment before the month's work (or 50% deposit on projects).
- ✓ **Use free software** — Wave, Stripe, PayPal or your bank auto-generate invoices.
- ✓ **Set clear terms** — "due on receipt" or "within 7 days", stated on the invoice.
- ✓ **Automate reminders** — the tool chases late payers for you.
- ✓ **Number & save every invoice** — you'll need them at tax time.

What goes on an invoice

- ✦ Your name/business & contact, an invoice number & date.
- ✦ The client, what you did, the amount & the due date.
- ✦ How to pay (bank details / payment link).

Deposits protect you. Always take money up front on new clients and projects — it filters out time-wasters and secures your income.

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TAX & MONEY

Keep what you earn.

Nobody's favourite subject — but staying on top of it keeps you free and stress-free. The basics are genuinely simple once set up.

The essentials

- ✦ **Put money aside for tax** — save ~**20–30%** of profit in a separate pot as you earn. Never spend it.
- ✦ **Track income & expenses** — a free tool (Wave) or even a spreadsheet.
- ✦ **Claim your expenses** — phone, laptop, subscriptions, ring light, travel, a % of home use — they lower your tax bill.
- ✦ **File on time** — the UK self-assessment deadline is 31 January; don't be late.

When to get an accountant

- ✦ Once you're earning steadily, an accountant (~£30–£100/mo) saves you more than they cost.
- ✦ They handle tax, tell you what you can claim, and free your time to earn.
- ✦ **Watch the VAT threshold** (£90k in the UK) — your accountant will guide you as you grow.

Set the tax pot up today — a second bank "pot" you send 25% into every time you're paid. Future-you never gets a nasty surprise.

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CONTRACTS & LEGAL

Protect yourself.

A simple contract protects you, sets expectations, and makes you look serious. You don't need a lawyer for a basic one — you need the right things written down.

Every client contract should cover

- ◆ **Scope** — exactly what's included, and what costs extra.
- ◆ **Price & payment terms** — amount, dates, method, late fees.
- ◆ **Term & cancellation** — rolling monthly, 30 days' notice.
- ◆ **Ownership & access** — who owns the content and logins.
- ◆ **Approvals & revisions** — how many, and turnaround.

Other bases to cover

- ◆ **#ad disclosure** — always label paid partnerships (it's the law).
- ◆ **Data / GDPR** — handle client logins & customer data responsibly.
- ◆ **Insurance** — professional indemnity is cheap and worth it as you grow.



Want a ready-to-use contract, invoice & onboarding template? **DM @lou1sethomson.**

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A woman with long brown hair and blue eyes is posing in a black and white bikini by a swimming pool. She is looking towards the camera with a slight smile. The background shows a pool with blue water, a concrete edge, and some greenery.

MODULE 10

Grow, Monetise & Scale

Stack multiple income streams, land brand deals, build a funnel that grows itself, and turn a solo hustle into a business that scales.

Income streams

Brand deals

Funnels & email

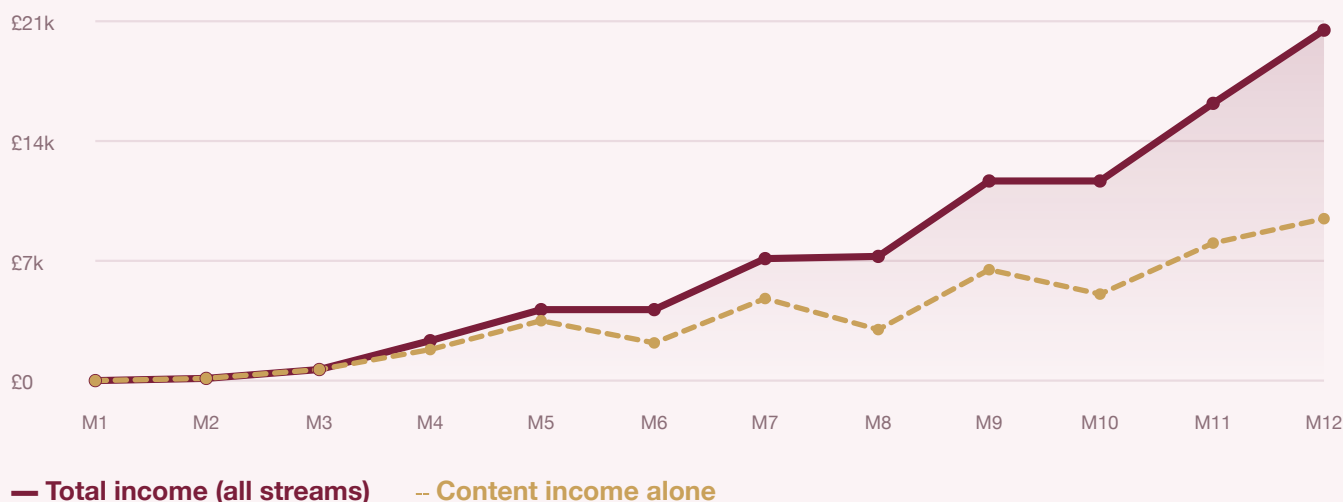
Scaling to an agency



HOW IT REALLY WENT

£0 to £20k — the real story.

Forget the fake "straight line up" graphs. Here's how it **actually** went — messy, with real dips in the months I posted less. The gold line is content income on its own. The wine line is my **total** once I built other streams.



See the gold dips at **months 6, 8 and 10**? Those are the months I travelled, got busy, or just didn't post enough — and content income fell hard. But look at the wine line: the **total barely flinched**. That's not luck — that's diversification doing its job.

Why the total kept climbing

- ✦ **Content is a rollercoaster.** Brand deals and views depend on you posting — miss a few weeks and it drops.
- ✦ **So I built income that doesn't need me to post:** social media management (paid monthly either way), website builds, SEO & Google for local businesses, and my own products.
- ✦ **Those streams are recurring or independent** — they filled every dip and stacked on top, carrying me from £0 to **£20k+ months**.

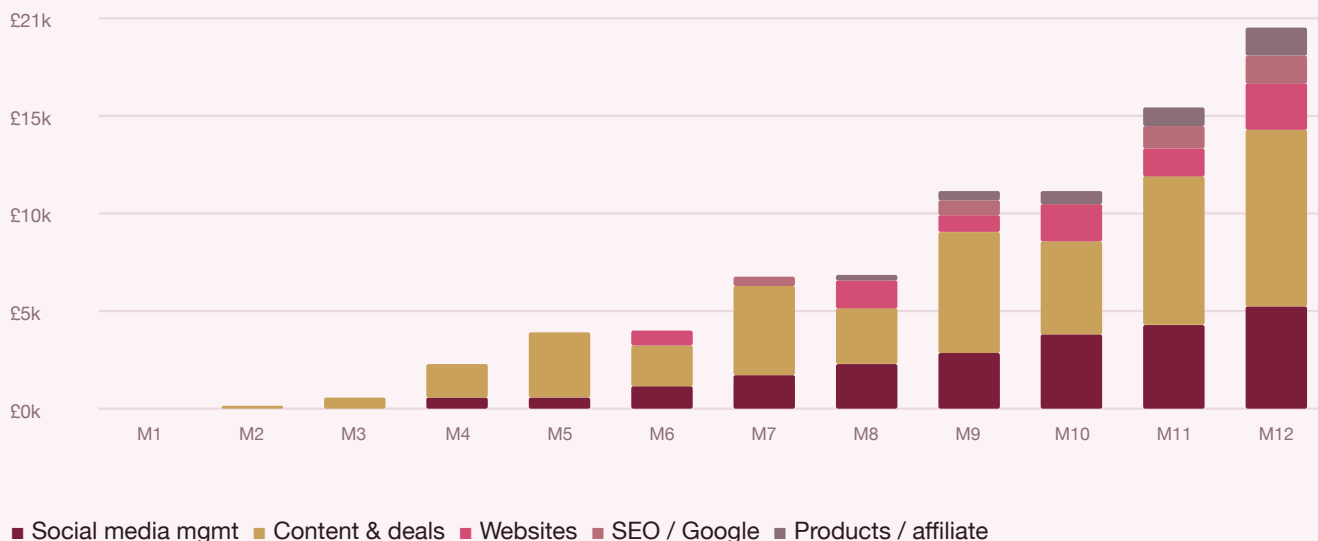
The lesson in one line: don't build a bigger content income — build **more income streams**. That's what turns a good month into a good year.



THE BREAKDOWN

How the streams stacked up.

The same 12 months, broken down by where the money came from. Watch the **gold (content)** wobble while the recurring streams grow underneath it — that's what carried the total to £20k+.



How each stream behaves

Stream	Behaviour	Role
Content & deals	Volatile, high ceiling	Big wins, but drops when you don't post
Social media mgmt	Recurring, predictable	The backbone — paid monthly regardless
Websites	Lumpy projects + care plans	Chunky cash + a recurring tail
SEO / Google	Project + retainer	Easy add-on for local clients
Products / affiliate	Passive, compounding	Small, grows while you sleep

Build the recurring ones first. Social media management and care plans pay you on the quiet months — that stability is what lets you take the swings on content without fear.



INCOME STREAMS

Never rely on one payday.

The creators who last don't have one income — they have several, feeding each other. Here's the mix and roughly how it balances out.



- ✦ **Brand deals** — paid posts; scale with your reach.
- ✦ **Client work** — SMM & websites; your reliable base.
- ✦ **UGC** — content for brands you don't even post yourself.
- ✦ **Affiliate & commissions** — earn a cut on every sale via your link.
- ✦ **Your own products** — guides, presets, courses; you keep almost all of it.

Add one at a time. Get one stream working before you start the next — don't spread yourself thin.

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EARN WHILE YOU SLEEP

Your content keeps working.

Here's the part that changes everything: you keep earning **even when you're not posting**. Do the work once, and it pays you again and again — this is how income grows exponentially with you.

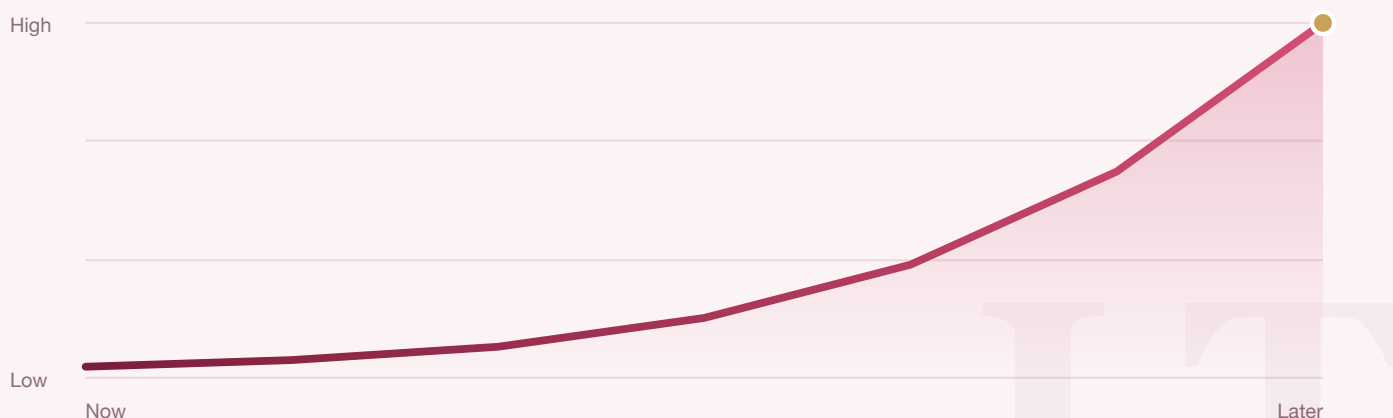
Your content doesn't expire

- ✦ **Evergreen posts keep selling.** A TikTok that did well stays out there — people find it days, weeks and months later and still buy.
- ✦ **One video, endless sales.** A single post can earn for you today, next week and next year. You filmed it once.
- ✦ **Your back-catalogue is an asset.** Every post becomes a little salesperson working 24/7 while you sleep, travel, or film the next one.

Income that needs no new work

- ✦ **Affiliate links** in old posts and your bio pay commissions around the clock.
- ✦ **Digital products** — guides, presets, courses — sell infinitely with nothing to restock.
- ✦ **Retainers & memberships** pay you every month for work you've already systemised.

Why it compounds: as your audience grows, every new post reaches more people — and your old posts keep pulling in that bigger audience too. Growth stacks on growth. That's the difference between a wage (linear) and an asset (exponential).



The goal: build assets — content, audience, products — once, and let them pay you on repeat.



Want more, or want it done for you? [DM @lou1sethomson](https://www.instagram.com/lou1sethomson)

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LAND BRAND DEALS

Get paid to post.

You don't need a million followers — brands pay **engaged, niche** creators of every size. You often have to make the first move.

How to land them

- ✦ **Tag & feature brands you already love** — show them what working with you looks like.
- ✦ **Pitch directly** — a short, confident email to their marketing team.
- ✦ **Have a media kit** — one page: who you are, your stats, past work, rates.
- ✦ **Sign up to creator platforms** that connect brands and creators.

The pitch email

"Hi [brand], I'm [name] — I create [niche] content for an audience of [who]. My recent posts have hit [reach/engagement] and your product is a perfect fit. I'd love to create [idea] for you — here's my media kit. Are you open to a collab?"

Know your worth. Charge per deliverable and per platform. As your reach grows, your rates grow — don't work for "exposure" once you can help it.

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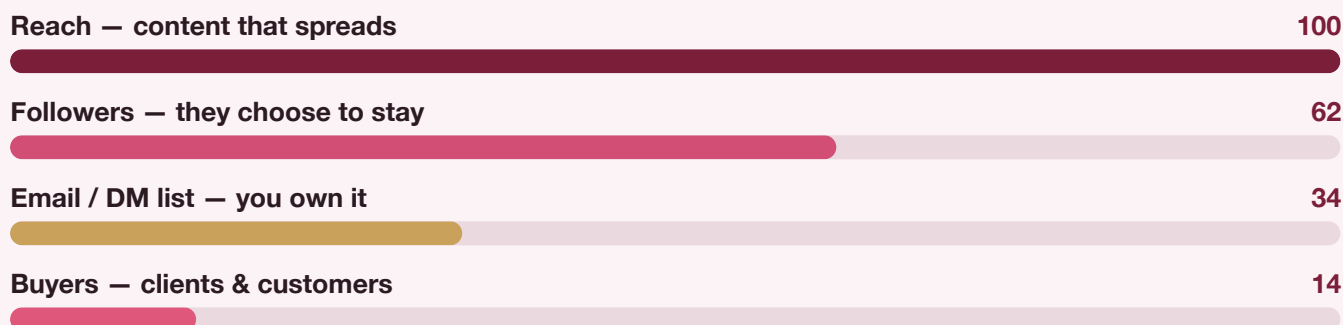


FUNNELS & SCALING

Build a machine.

To grow past yourself you need a **funnel** (attention → audience → income) and eventually a **team** so the business doesn't depend only on you.

The simple creator funnel



- ✦ **Capture the audience you own** — an email list or a "DM me X" system beats renting followers.
- ✦ **Nurture** — give value, build trust, then make offers.
- ✦ **Repurpose** — one idea into TikTok, Reels, Shorts, a post and an email.

Scaling to an agency

- ✦ **Systemise** everything into templates and checklists (like this playbook).
- ✦ **Outsource** the parts you don't need to do — editing first, then posting.
- ✦ **Raise prices** and take on fewer, better clients.

Do this now: start collecting emails/DMs today — the audience you own is the most valuable asset you'll build.

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MODULE 11

Launch — Your First 90 Days

Turn everything into action: the tools, a day-by-day 90-day plan, the numbers to watch, and the mistakes that quietly sink most beginners before they start.

Tool stack

90-day plan

Track KPIs

Avoid mistakes



TOOLS & TECH STACK

Everything you need (mostly free).

You can run this whole business from your phone and a laptop. Here's the complete toolkit — start with the free ones.

Create

- ✦ **CapCut / InShot** — editing
- ✦ **Canva** — graphics, branding, templates
- ✦ **Lightroom** — photo editing

Manage

- ✦ **Later / Metricool** — scheduling & analytics
- ✦ **Notion / Trello** — plan clients & content
- ✦ **Google Drive** — store & share content

Get paid

- ✦ **Wave / PayPal / Stripe** — invoices
- ✦ **Wise** — get paid internationally

Grow

- ✦ **ChatGPT** — ideas, captions, outreach drafts
- ✦ **Website builder** — Wix, Squarespace, Carrd
- ✦ **A link-in-bio** — Stan, Beacons, Linktree

Don't buy everything. Start with CapCut, Canva and a free scheduler. Add tools only when a real need appears.

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YOUR FIRST 90 DAYS

The exact plan.

Here's how to turn this guide into income. Follow it and you'll have posted consistently, pitched real clients, and set up to get paid — in three months.

Phase	Focus	Goal
Days 1–7	Pick path & niche, set up profile & bio, write 10 hooks	Ready to launch
Days 8–30	Post daily, learn the hook system, batch content	First content out, first followers
Days 31–60	Build brand kit & a demo site, list your packages, start outreach	Booked first calls
Days 61–90	Close your first client, deliver, get a testimonial, raise prices	First paid income 🎉

Consistency beats talent, every time.

The people who win aren't the most gifted — they're the ones who kept posting, kept pitching, and kept improving when others quit.

Do this now: put these four phases in your calendar with a start date. Today.

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TRACK YOUR NUMBERS

What gets measured grows.

You don't need to obsess over analytics — but check a few numbers weekly so you know what's working and double down.

Your weekly dashboard

Reach

How many people saw you — the top of everything

Engagement

Saves, shares & comments — quality of attention

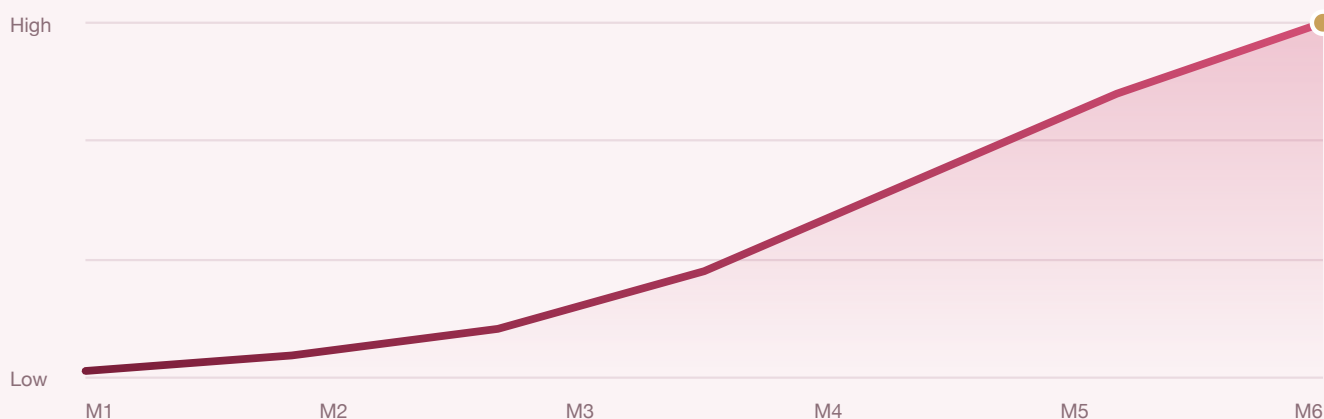
Followers

Growth rate, not just the total

Income

Leads, clients & £ — the number that counts

Example: 6 months of consistent effort



It's a curve, not a line. The first weeks feel slow — that's normal. Momentum compounds. Keep going and the graph takes off.

Rule: review weekly, adjust monthly, never quit on a bad week.

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MISTAKES TO AVOID

Don't trip over these.

Most people who quit didn't fail at the work — they made avoidable mistakes and lost heart. Sidestep these and you're already ahead of 90% of beginners.

The big ones

- ✦ **Waiting to be "ready".** Perfect never comes. Post the imperfect video today.
- ✦ **Posting randomly.** No niche, no plan, no consistency = no growth. Use a system.
- ✦ **Copying, not adapting.** Learn from what works, but sound like you.
- ✦ **Undercharging.** Cheap attracts nightmare clients and burns you out. Price on value.
- ✦ **No contract or deposit.** The fastest way to get burned. Always both.
- ✦ **Chasing followers, not income.** A small engaged audience out-earns a big passive one.
- ✦ **Quitting at week 3.** Growth is a curve — it's always slow before it isn't.
- ✦ **Doing everything alone.** Systemise and outsource before you burn out.

The meta-mistake: treating this like a hobby. Treat it like the business it is — show up daily, track numbers, get paid properly — and it will pay you like one.



Stuck or unsure of your next step? **DM @lou1sethomson** — a two-line message could save you months.

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MODULE 12

Done For You & AI

Don't want to do it yourself? My team does everything — content, management, websites, branding and full AI systems. Plus learn AI directly from my engineers.

Done-for-you

Websites (no Shopify needed)

AI engineering

Learn AI



DONE FOR YOU

Or... we just do it all.

This guide shows you how to do it yourself — but plenty of people and businesses would rather hand it over. That's exactly what my team is for. You focus on your business; we run the rest.

What we take off your plate

- ✦ **Content creation** — filmed, edited, posted
- ✦ **Full social media management** — every platform
- ✦ **Branding** — identity, templates, guidelines
- ✦ **Paid ads** — set up & managed
- ✦ **Websites & online shops** — built for you
- ✦ **Strategy** — a plan that actually grows you
- ✦ **Reporting** — clear results each month
- ✦ **Whatever you need** — just ask

No Shopify? No problem. Don't want to learn Shopify, editing software or website builders? You don't have to. We build and run it all for you — you never touch the tech.

Perfect for

- ✦ **Businesses & companies** that want a professional presence without the hassle.
- ✦ **Busy founders** who know they need social media but have no time.
- ✦ **Creators** who want to scale but can't do everything alone.



Want it done for you? Tell us your goal and we'll build the plan. **DM @lou1sethomson** for a quote.

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AI THAT DOES THE WORK

A full AI engineering team.

Here's what makes us different: behind me is a **full team of AI engineers** who can build almost anything. AI isn't the future — it's how smart creators and businesses win right now.

What we can build for you



AI automation

Systems that handle the repetitive work — replies, DMs, scheduling, lead follow-up — 24/7.



Chatbots & voice agents

AI that answers customers, books appointments and sells, on your site or phone line.



Custom AI tools

Content engines, dashboards, apps — bespoke software built around your business.

- ✦ **Save hours every week** — let AI handle the busywork so you create and sell.
- ✦ **Scale without hiring** — one AI system can do the work of a small team.
- ✦ **Stay ahead** — most of your competition hasn't caught on yet. Be early.

Whatever you can imagine, we can likely build. Creators, coaches, shops, agencies, big companies — if it can be automated or made smarter with AI, my engineers can do it.



Got an idea, or a bottleneck you want gone? **DM @lou1sethomson** and my AI team will tell you what's possible.

LT





LEARN AI DIRECT

Learn AI from my engineer.

Want to learn this yourself and become unstoppable? You can learn AI **directly with my AI engineer** — the same person who builds our systems. It's the skill that will define the next decade.

What you'll learn

- ✦ **Prompt engineering** — get world-class results from AI, every time.
- ✦ **Automate your content** — ideas, scripts, captions, repurposing at speed.
- ✦ **Build AI tools & automations** — even with no coding background.
- ✦ **Use AI to run a business** — admin, marketing, customer service, sales.

Why it matters: the people who learn to use AI now will out-earn and out-work everyone who doesn't. Learning it directly from an engineer who builds real systems is the fastest way in.

Ways to learn

1:1 sessions

Personal training on exactly what you want to build.

Group courses

Step-by-step programmes to learn AI from scratch.

In the Academy

AI modules built right into the Louise Thomson Academy.



Ready to learn AI with my engineer? **DM @lou1sethomson** to join the next intake.

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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SWIPE FILE

Steal these — they work.

Save this page. These are plug-and-play starting points for the things you'll do most — swap in your own words and go.

10 hooks to open any video

- ◆ "Stop doing this if you want to grow."
- ◆ "Nobody tells you this about..."
- ◆ "How I went from ___ to ___."
- ◆ "3 things I wish I knew before..."
- ◆ "Watch this before you..."
- ◆ "POV: you finally..."
- ◆ "The fastest way to..."
- ◆ "I tried ___ for 30 days — here's what happened."
- ◆ "This ___ mistake is costing you ___."
- ◆ "Save this if you..."

Client outreach DM

"Hi [name], I love what you do at [business]. I put together a couple of quick content ideas that could bring you more [result] — want me to send them over? No strings, I just work with local businesses like yours."

Brand-deal pitch

"Hi [brand], I'm [name] — I create [niche] content for [audience]. Recent posts hit [reach]. Your product is a perfect fit — I'd love to make [idea]. Media kit attached. Open to a collab?"



Want the full templates pack — contract, invoice, media kit & 50 hooks? **DM @lou1sethomson.**

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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RESOURCES

Everything in one place.

The tools I actually use and recommend — most are free. Don't buy everything; start with the free ones and add as you grow.

Create

- ✦ **CapCut / InShot** — video editing
- ✦ **Canva** — graphics & branding
- ✦ **Lightroom** — photo editing

Plan & manage

- ✦ **Notion / Trello** — clients & content
- ✦ **Later / Metricool** — scheduling & analytics
- ✦ **Google Drive** — storage

Get paid & run it

- ✦ **Starling / Tide** — business banking
- ✦ **Stripe / PayPal / Wave** — payments & invoices
- ✦ **GoCardless** — retainer direct debits

Grow & build

- ✦ **ChatGPT** — ideas, captions, outreach
- ✦ **Wix / Squarespace / Carrd** — websites
- ✦ **Stan / Beacons** — link-in-bio & products

Your starter stack (all free): CapCut + Canva + a scheduler + a free business bank + Wave for invoices. That's a whole business, for £0.

LT





Louise Thomson
THE PLAYBOOK

YOU'VE GOT THE MAP — NOW GET THE GUIDE

Let's do this together.

This playbook gives you the what. My Academy gives you the how — with me — step by step, with feedback, templates, and a community doing it alongside you.

The Louise Thomson Academy is opening soon.

Full video training on everything in this guide — content, social media management, branding, websites, pricing and scaling — plus live Q&As, a resource vault, and a bookable creator directory once you're ready to get paid. **Follow me and turn on notifications** to be first in — early members get the best price.

Join the waitlist — follow @lou1sethomson



Instagram — [instagram.com/lou1sethomson](https://www.instagram.com/lou1sethomson)



TikTok — [tiktok.com/@lou1sethomsonx](https://www.tiktok.com/@lou1sethomsonx)